

Naming — Consolidated Findings (single source of truth)

Last updated: 2026-07-16. Supersedes and folds together: `Naming-Round-4.md` (this folder) and the four archived rounds in `docs/99 Pruned/` (*Options, Deep-Dive, Wordplay, Round-3*), plus the live domain/brand availability work done in the 2026-07-15 → 07-16 sessions. The older docs are kept for provenance; **this is the doc to read**.

The product currently ships under the working title **"Family Chronicle."** The design system is separately named **Kindred**. The original working name was **"Kith."** No final brand has ever been committed to `DECISIONS.md` or an ADR — the decision is still open.

1. What the name has to carry (constraints)

From the vision doc, unchanged across every round:

- **The attic, not StoryWorth.** The competitor is the unlabeled shoebox / trunk / the one relative who "knew all the family history." The product *is* the well-kept version of the attic.
- **A living institution, not a one-time gift.** It "outlives any single contributor." Not a disposable app-store-cute name.
- **Dignity and warmth for elders.** No condescension, no baby-talk, no slang. A grandmother should say it with pride.
- **Perpetual chronicle.** One chronicle underneath, many modes on top; "render a snapshot from a stream that never stops."

2. Hard rulings (do not re-litigate)

- **clan- is BANNED.** Spoken aloud, "Clan-X" is phonetically indistinguishable from **"Klan-X."** For a heritage/bloodline product this is the worst possible adjacency. This kills Clanark, Clankeep, Clanhearth, Clanharbor, Clancoffer, Clantrove, Clancapsule and every other clan- combo **regardless of clean availability**. (Decided 2026-07-16. Clanark had been the session frontrunner before this ruling.)
- **kin- is the single most picked-over root.** Every legible kin-compound comes back with the `.com` gone: Kinkeeper (live eldercare product), Kinstory (`.com` + `.co` held), Kinsaga (two live family apps, one branded "Family Operating System"), Kinchest (`.com` parked). The more on-thesis the kin-word, the more likely it's already a product.
- **Burned words (multiple live products each) — avoid bare use:** Heirloom, Airloom, Kindred, Keepsake, Trove, Locket, Saga, Griot, Hearth (solo).
- **The legibility ↔ ownability vise.** The names that read instantly (kinchest, sagakin, legasee, loomwell, everlore) are *taken*; the ones that are *available* need a root you have to teach (kith-). This is the central tension — pick which side you'll accept.
- **Active land-rush.** Many collisions were registered in **2026** (kithloom Jun, kithlore May, loomkeep Jun, hearthark Feb, kithkeep Jan...). This territory is being claimed monthly; a clean name today may not be clean in a month.

3. Live competitors / namesakes found (2026-07-16 web scan)

Name	What it is	Consequence
OurTales (ourtales.com)	German story-to-book memory product — "Deine Geschichte. Als Buch verewigt."	Direct competitor. Kills ourtale/ourtales.

Legasee (legasee.org.uk)	UK charity filming military veterans' oral histories	Adjacent competitor. Kills legasee.
Kinsaga (kinsaga.com/.app)	"Family Operating System" + a family-legacy app	Kills kinsaga.
Saga	Funded family-memory app	Root "saga-" launches adjacent to it.
Hearth Tales (hearthtales.com)	Live NZ interview/storytelling project	Namesake collision for hearthtales.
Kinkeeper (kinkeeper.com/.app)	Family eldercare / check-in platform	Kills kinkeeper.
Progeni (progeni.io)	"Do good. Earn karma." app + a 1996 .com holder	Kills progeni.
Lorelock (lorelock.com)	Live JS web app (domain unknown)	Namesake for lorelock.
Joolz, Whispr Group, Yarnkin	Strollers / marketing agency / Icelandic kids' books	Real brands, low adjacency but present.

4. History of the four earlier rounds (archived)

- Round 1 — Options:** Vellum (rec.), Mantel, Loomwell, Cedarchest, Trousseau, Keepwell, Marrow, Wend.
- Round 2 — Deep-Dive:** killed **Everloom** (crowded TM) and **Vellum** (collides with the ebook-formatting tool → survives only as a compound). Pivoted to the trunk-in-the-attic metaphor → Cedarwell, Stowe, Trovekeep.
- Wordplay worksheet:** roots + portmanteaus across Saga/Family/Trunk/Quilt/Heirloom → Sagestry, Arkive, Kithloom.
- Round 3 (reset for "more spine"):** the earlier names judged too soft → Edda, Recount, Anvil.
- Round 4 (your liked set):** Arkive, Sagahold, Sagakeep, Stitchkin, Patchwork, Ark, Sagastry, Legasee, SagaArk, Sagakin → finalists **Sagastry · Sagakin · Stitchkin · Legasee · SagaArk**. First-pass flags: Arkive & Patchwork crowded; the Saga- coinages the most ownable.

Recurring next-step never taken: a real USPTO class search + live domain check on the finalists.

5. Availability ledger — 2026-07-16 (authoritative RDAP + live fetch)

5a. Clean cluster survivors (.com + .family both open) — the real candidates

Name	Read	Honest take
kithchest	the kith's chest	Most legible ownable survivor. "Chest" = the trunk-in-the-attic metaphor, said plainly. Cost: "kith" is archaic to many ears — teach the root.
Kithkist	the kith's chest (Scots <i>kist</i>)	Most distinctive/ownable , alliterative, Scots-coherent. Cost: two obscure words.
everkith	ever (perpetual) + kith	On-thesis with "perpetual chronicle." "ever-" slightly generic; "kith" opacity again.

Folkkeep	where the folk are kept	"Folk" more recognizable than "kith"; warm, plain, a touch generic.
Kithcoffer / Folkcoffer / Heircoffer / Rootcoffer	strongbox	Clean, but "coffer" reads <i>money/funds</i> .
Kithhold / Hallhold / Kithtrove / Folkkist / Hearthkist	vessel combos	Clean but obscure/mouthfuls, or "trove" (busy).

5b. Rich meaning but .com gone (launch on .family / .app)

- **Heirward** — "kept for the heirs." Dignified, coined. (.family / .app / .co)
- **Familiary** — "where the family is kept." Warm, distinctive. (.family / .app)

5c. Near-misses — available below .com , but bare .com held (recall/ownership risk)

- **Kinstory** — .com + .co held (thin placeholder), .family / .app open.
- **Sagakin** — .com a live minimal "Sagakin" page (reg 2026-02).
- **Kinchest** — .com parked on Namecheap (reg 2026-01) — possibly *acquirable*.
- **Generark** — .com a live solar-generator brand.

5d. Dead (taken by a live/established thing, or trademark cloud)

Everloom (US/AU trademarks + .com 2015 + .family taken 2026-05) · Legasee (UK charity, .com 2009, .family taken 2023) · Progeni (.io live, .com 1996) · Kinkeeper · Kinsaga · Fambook (Facebook "-book" TM turf) · "All in the Family" (sitcom) · Loomwell (.com 2019) · Everlore (.com 1999) · Kinlore · Kithloom / Kithlore / Loomkeep / Loomhold (all grabbed 2025–2026) · onebig.family (domainer hold since 2018).

5e. .family phrase-hacks (memorable doorways, weak as ownable marks)

Available: partofthe.family , keepitinthe.family , thewhole.family , tellmeagain.family , tellitagain.family , tellusagain.family , tellme.family , tellmeabout.family , tellmemore.family , tellthefam.family , tellthefamily.family . Taken: gather.family , inthe.family , onebig.family .

*"Tell me again" is the strongest phrase — it's literally what you say to a grandparent, no sitcom baggage. Best used as a **tagline/doorway over a real coined name**, not as the sole (unownable) brand.*

6. The 58-name list (2026-07-16) — .com adjacency scan

Every domain on the submitted list (the .family / .app / .com actually chosen) is AVAILABLE. The classification below is only about *what sits on the base .com* .

TLD legend:  available ·  registered (no product / a live brand — see comment) ·  parked for-sale (buyable).

 Real brand on the .com — adjacency risk

All have .com taken by a live brand; .family / .app / .co are open. The .com column names what's actually there.

Name	.com	.family	.app	.co	What's on the .com — comment	Risk
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ourtales	✗	✓	✓	✓	OurTales — German story-to-book memory product ("Deine Geschichte. Als Buch verewigt")	● Direct competitor — kill
ourtale	✗	✓	✓	✓	Singular of the above; same OurTales brand	● Kill
hearthtales	✗	✓	✓	✓	Hearth Tales — live NZ interview/storytelling site	● Namesake, storytelling niche
lorelock	✗	✓	✓	✓	Lorelock — live JS web app, domain unknown	● Namesake
sagakin	✗	✓	✓	✓	Minimal live "Sagakin" landing page (reg 2026-02)	● Exact-name hold; also "saga-" burned
yarnkin	✗	✓	✓	✓	Yarnkin — Icelandic children's-book library (2026)	● Diff space, but yarn=story/kin=family
joolz	✗	✓	✓	✓	Joolz — premium baby strollers (strong mark)	● Diff category, real brand next door
whispr	✗	✓	✓	✓	Whispr Group — marketing/comms agency	● Dated dropped-vowel spelling — pass

● .com parked for sale (no brand — acquirable, or just take your TLD)

.family / .app / .co all open. .com is a domainer parking page (no product), so it's buyable if you ever wanted it — or ignorable.

Name	.com	.family	.app	.co	.com status — comment
familychronicles	👛	✓	✓	✓	HugeDomains for-sale parking. Legible, echoes working title; "chronicle" generic in-category.
kronicles	👛	✓	✓	✓	HugeDomains for-sale parking. K-respelling reads gimmicky/downmarket.
shutupandlisten	👛	✓	✓	✓	HugeDomains for-sale parking. Bold/funny phrase; wrong dignity register for elders.

● .com registered but dormant/blank (no brand, no threat)

.family / .app / .co all open. The .com is registered but shows no product — either not hosted, a blank page, or a default placeholder. Not a competitor; the only cost is you can't have the .com and (for the famous ones) recall is muddled.

Name	.com	.family	.app	.co	.com — reg date & what's there	Brand-read comment
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familyfold	✗	✓	✓	✓	2008 — blank (parking IP)	"the family fold" — warm idiom, legible; generic.
familylore	✗	✓	✓	✓	2008 — no response	family + lore — on-thesis, legible; "family-" weak IP.
famlore	✗	✓	✓	✓	2019 — blank (Apache)	fam + lore — tighter; "fam-" slang tint.
fistory	✗	✓	✓	✓	2016 — no response	"family history" contraction — but reads "fist-ory"/awkward.
genography	✗	✓	✓	✓	2005 — not hosted	gene/genealogy + -graphy — clinical; Nat-Geo "Genographic" echo.
gensaga	✗	✓	✓	✓	2017 — not hosted	generation + saga — opaque; saga- adjacency.
hearthlore	✗	✓	✓	✓	2024 — no response	hearth + lore — warm, on-thesis; "hearth" burned solo.
heritagehub	✗	✓	✓	✓	2015 — not hosted	legible but corporate/generic ("-hub").
legendline	✗	✓	✓	✓	2006 — not hosted	legend + line of descent — decent; slightly grandiose.
lorelocker	✗	✓	✓	✓	2026-06-30 — not hosted (just grabbed)	lore + locker — "locker" feels transactional/gym.
memento	✗	✓	✓	✓	2011 — blank (AWS)	memento + momentum — evocative coinage; opaque.
sagaly	✗	✓	✓	✓	2025 — blank (AWS)	saga + -ly — reads adverb/SaaS; saga- adjacency.
sagascap	✗	✓	✓	✓	2020 — no response	saga + -scape — landscape-y; opaque.
sagatree	✗	✓	✓	✓	2016 — blank	saga + tree — family-tree legible; saga- adjacency.
vestigen	✗	✓	✓	✓	2013 — blank (Apache)	vestige + gen — "traces of lineage"; reads biotech.
kinlog	✗	✓	✓	✓	2014 — default cPanel placeholder	kin + log — utilitarian/techy, not warm.
tellitagain	✗	✓	✓	✓	2005 — blank	phrase-hack, warm; unownable idiom.

tellme	✗	✓	✓	✓	1999 — blank (was Microsoft Tellme Networks)	short/warm; famous-name recall baggage.
tellmeabout	✗	✓	✓	✓	1999 — blank	phrase-hack ("tell me about..."); unownable.
tellmeagain	✗	✓	✓	✓	1999 — blank	strongest phrase ("tell me again"); best as a tagline/doorway.
tellmemore	✗	✓	✓	✓	1995 — no response (a 1990s TELL ME MORE language brand)	warm CTA; historical namesake dents recall.

● .com ALSO free — whole cluster ownable

Every TLD (.com / .family / .app / .co) is open for all of these — you could own the full footprint. Ranked roughly best→weakest by brand read. Two shared caveats: **"saga-"** launches adjacent to the funded Saga family-memory app; **"fam-"** imports a casual/slang register that fights the elder-dignity bar.

Name	.com	.family	.app	.co	Reads as	Comment
sagavessel	✓	✓	✓	✓	the vessel carrying the family saga	On-thesis (vessel = your core metaphor), distinctive, legible. Two syllables long; saga-adjacency. Best of the group.
sagafolia	✓	✓	✓	✓	saga + <i>folia</i> (leaves/pages)	Pretty, coinable, distinctive. Meaning is opaque without a beat; saga- adjacency.
famchronicles	✓	✓	✓	✓	the family chronicles	Legible, echoes the working title. "Chronicle" is generic in-category; "fam-" tint.
famchronicle	✓	✓	✓	✓	the family chronicle	Singular of above; same read.
sagamoir	✓	✓	✓	✓	saga + memoir	On-thesis (saga-memoir), distinctive. Spelling/pronunciation friction ("-moir").
sagafold	✓	✓	✓	✓	saga + fold (enfold / a flock's fold)	Warm, distinctive; saga-adjacency.
famfolia	✓	✓	✓	✓	family + <i>folia</i> (leaves/pages)	Pretty, coinable; opaque meaning + "fam-" tint.

sagakive	✓	✓	✓	✓	saga + archive	Clever ("the archive of sagas"); hard to spell/say aloud.
kinfolkkeeper	✓	✓	✓	✓	keeper of the kinfolk	On-thesis meaning, but long, triple-k mouthful, echoes <i>Kinfolk</i> magazine.
sagalibre	✓	✓	✓	✓	saga + <i>libre</i> (free / book)	Distinctive; "libre" carries an open-source connotation.
sagafam	✓	✓	✓	✓	the saga fam	Short, punchy; both saga-adjacency and "fam-" slang tint.
familisaga	✓	✓	✓	✓	<i>familia</i> + saga	Legible-ish, warm; long, saga-adjacency.
famisaga	✓	✓	✓	✓	fam + saga	Shorter; saga- adjacency + "fam-" tint.
kinicle	✓	✓	✓	✓	kin + chronicle	Coined, short; opaque, reads near "icle/cubicle".
sagathos	✓	✓	✓	✓	saga + ethos/pathos	Greek gravitas; opaque, reads pharma/tech.
sagalogy	✓	✓	✓	✓	saga + -logy	Reads academic ("-ology"); flat.
familipages	✓	✓	✓	✓	family pages	Legible but clunky/long; "-pages" is dated (yellowpages).
famkronicle	✓	✓	✓	✓	family chronicle (K-spelled)	Legible, but the K-respelling reads gimmicky/downmarket.
sagalegy	✓	✓	✓	✓	saga + elegy/legacy	Ambiguous — mumbles toward "strategy/sacrilege".
sagantry	✓	✓	✓	✓	saga + -antry (tapestry?)	Opaque, hard to parse.
famicles	✓	✓	✓	✓	fam + chronicles	Odd cadence, reads near "popsicles". Weak.
tellthefamily	✓	✓	✓	✓	"tell the family"	Legible, warm CTA; unownable-phrase weakness, long.
tellthefam	✓	✓	✓	✓	"tell the fam"	Punchy phrase; casual "fam" slang register.

7. Where it stands / recommended next step

Clean, ownable, legible-enough shortlist (my ranking):

1. **kithchest** — clean cluster, legible metaphor (teach "kith").
2. **Kithkist** / **everkith** — clean, more distinctive, more opaque.
3. **Folkkeep** — clean, plainer/warmer root.

4. **Heirward / Familiary** — richer meaning, .family / .app only.

5. From the whole-cluster-free green group: **sagavessel, famchronicle(s), sagafolia/famfolia, tellthefamily.**

Doorway/tagline (pair with a real name): tellmeagain.family .

The actual decision is a tradeoff, not another candidate:

- Clean + legible → **kithchest** (accept teaching "kith")
- Clean + distinctive → **Kithkist / everkith**
- Rich meaning, no .com → **Heirward / Familiary**
- Buy a legible .com → acquire **kinchest.com / kinstory.com** from their parkers

Outstanding (never done): USPTO class search on the top 3–4, and a full web/app-store product scan to confirm no stealth namesake. This is the real gate before committing — availability ≠ clearance.